

Embedding Zero Trust Security into Your Infrastructure



Developers must design and operate systems that are built on the tenet of zero trust.

In early 2024, the ‘Midnight Blizzard’ attack proved that even tech giants are vulnerable when they rely on implicit trust; hackers compromised a single legacy test account and used it to move laterally, eventually accessing Microsoft’s internal corporate emails and source code. This is a massive wake-up call for developers because it shows that the old ‘castle-and-moat’ security model is simply not enough anymore.

In today’s world of remote work and multi-cloud setups, there is no single boundary to protect, and once a hacker gets inside, they can move around

way too easily. Zero Trust (ZT) is a major philosophy shift that moves our defences away from static network walls to focus directly on protecting our users, assets, and actual data resources. It is not just a single product you can buy off the shelf or a simple MFA setup; it is a mindset and a set of guiding principles for how we design and operate our systems every single day.

At the heart of this approach is the ‘Assume Breach’ reality. We have to work under the premise that an attacker may already be sitting inside our environment, so we stop giving implicit trust to anyone just because

they are on the office Wi-Fi or using a company laptop. Instead of trusting once and forgetting about it, we continually analyse and verify every single access request. By shrinking these ‘trust zones’ and making access control very granular, we ensure that even if one account is compromised, the damage is contained and the attacker cannot easily jump to other sensitive parts of the network.

Core pillars of the ZT model

The ‘Never Trust, Always Verify’ pillar is the foundation of Zero Trust, where we completely remove the idea of an